Conversation — track 8, 10, 11

It's seven o'clock on Friday evening. Jerome and Priya are still at the office, and they have a big pitch on Monday.

Jerome: Right, I don't know about you, but I'm ready to **call it a day**.

Priya: Same here. I've been **burning the midnight oil** all week.

Jerome: You do look a bit **under the weather**, actually. Are you all right?

Priya: Just tired. It's been **one of those weeks**, you know?

Jerome: Too right. Before we go, are we **on the same page** about Monday?

Priya: I think so. You **break the ice**, and I'll handle the numbers.

Jerome: Perfect. Now go home and **put your feet up**. That's an order!

Priya: You don't have to tell me twice. Have a great weekend!

Study Notes

You break the ice, and I'll handle the numbers.
Anh mở màn cho không khí thoải mái, còn em lo phần số liệu.
"break the ice" là phá băng: nói vài câu mở đầu để mọi người bớt ngại.
"handle" là phụ trách, xử lý.
Cách nói tương đương: You start, and I'll do the numbers.

You don't have to tell me twice.
Không cần nhắc lần hai đâu (mình về ngay đây)!
Đáp lại vui vẻ khi ai bảo mình làm một việc mà mình đang rất muốn làm.
Cách nói tương đương: Say no more!

Speak Like a Native — track 9

1. Right, I don't know about you, but I'm ready to call it a day.
change: "don't know" (mất âm t)
linking: "call‿it‿a‿day"
strong: "ready", "day"
Ngắt ba cụm: "Right," / "I don't know about you," / "but I'm ready to call it a day". "call it a day" nối thành "co-li-tơ-đây" (giọng Anh giữ /t/).

2. I've been burning the midnight oil all week.
weak: "I've been"
linking: "midnight‿oil‿all"
strong: "midnight oil", "week"
"I've been" đọc nhanh, nhẹ: "aiv-bin". Giọng Mỹ: t → d nhẹ, cả cụm nối thành "mít-nai-đoi-lol".

3. It's been one of those weeks, you know?
linking: "one‿of"
weak: "of"
strong: "those"
"one of" nối thành "wa-nơv". Nhấn "those": "những tuần như thế" (ai cũng hiểu là tệ). "you know?" lên giọng nhẹ, mời người nghe đồng cảm.

- Thành ngữ đọc liền như một từ dài: call it a day → "co-li-tơ-đây" (giọng Mỹ: "co-li-đơ-đây").
- Câu dài chia thành cụm ngắn theo ý, ngừng nhẹ ở dấu phẩy.
- Trong "one of those weeks / days", nhấn "those" để người nghe tự hiểu là chẳng có gì suôn sẻ.

Grammar Focus

Thành ngữ về công việc: call it a day / burn the midnight oil / on the same page

call it a day = nghỉ, dừng làm việc; burn the midnight oil = thức khuya làm việc, học bài; be on the same page = hiểu và thống nhất với nhau.

We're all exhausted. Let's **call it a day**.
She's **burning the midnight oil** before her exams.
Let's meet first so we're **on the same page**.

Thành ngữ về sức khoẻ, nghỉ ngơi: under the weather / put your feet up

feel under the weather = hơi mệt, khó ở; put your feet up = ngồi nghỉ thư giãn; one of those days / weeks = ngày, tuần chẳng có gì suôn sẻ.

I'm feeling a bit **under the weather** today.
After work, I just want to **put my feet up**.
Nothing's going right. It's **one of those days**.

Role Play — track 13

A: Right, I don't know about you, but I'm ready to call it a day.

B: Same here. I've been _____ all week.

A: You do look a bit under the weather, actually. Are you all right?

B: Just tired. It's been _____, you know?

A: Too right. Before we go, are we on the same page about Monday?

B: I think so. You _____, and I'll handle the numbers.

A: Perfect. Now go home and put your feet up. That's an order!

B: You don't have to tell me twice. Have a great weekend!

Substitution Drill — track 14

1. I've been burning the midnight oil all week.
   a. snowed under
   b. running on empty
   c. working flat out

2. It's been one of those weeks, you know?
   a. a long week
   b. a crazy few days
   c. nonstop since Monday

3. You break the ice, and I'll handle the numbers.
   a. kick things off
   b. do the intro
   c. warm them up